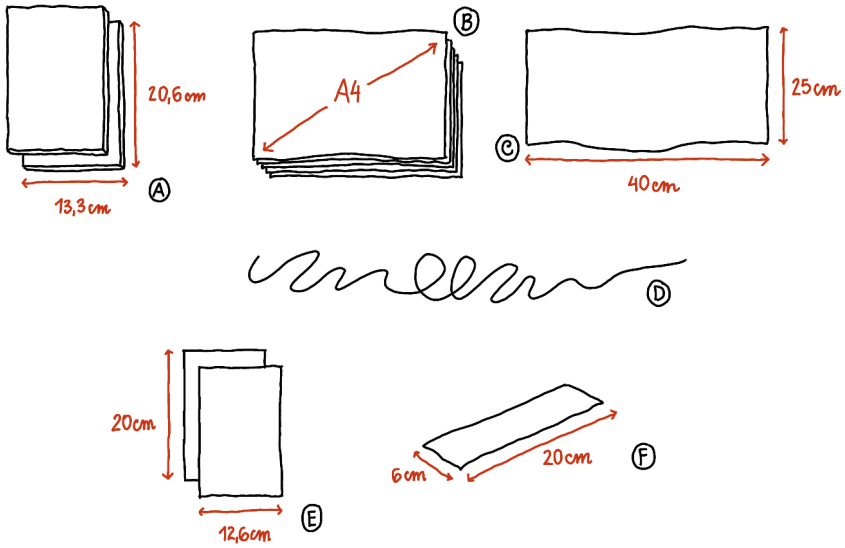
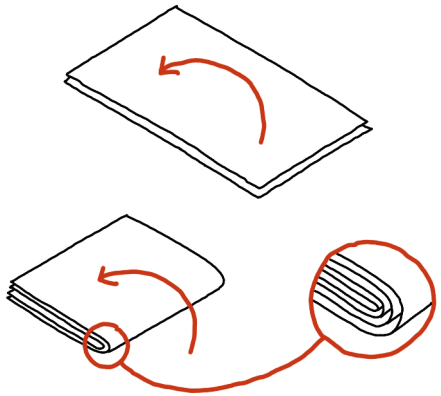
Making a single case binding

MATERIALS

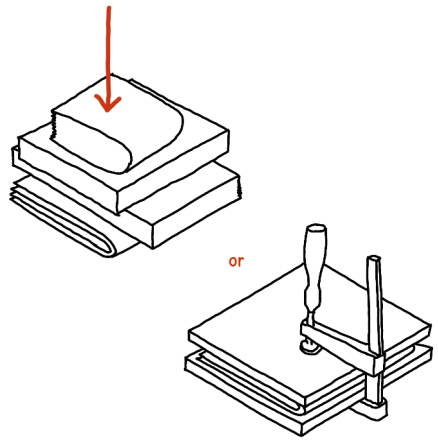
A. 2x CARDBOARD, 20,6x13,3cm (choose thickness, I use 2mm)
B. 20x SHEETS OF YOUR FAVOURITE PAPER (If you choose grammage above 80g, use 15 sheets instead- I use A4 size that are later cut down to size)
C. 1x BOOK CLOTH (in your favourite colour or patterns)
D. 1x WAXED THREAD
E. 2x SHEETS TO BE USED AS PAPER-ENDS, 12,6x20cm
F. MATCHING PIECE OF FABRIC FOR INSIDE LINING, 6x20cm





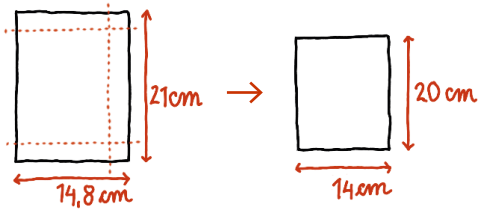
1. PREPARE THE SIGNATURE - BOOK BLOCK

This book block will be made of one signature. Take and fold all 20 sheets in half at the same time (do not fold them individually). Use a bone folder to help you here. The goal is to have a nice round folded profile.



2. LEAVE UNDER PRESSURE

Use some heavy books for that or your homemade presser.



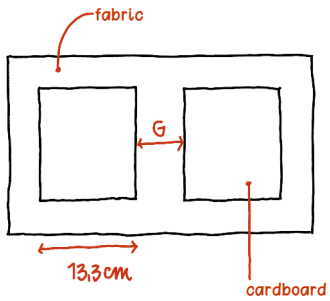
* The final size is up to your choice.

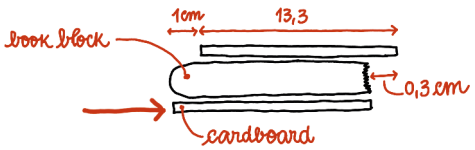
The important thing is to have the final size of the book block so we can use the measurement as a reference to make the covers. The covers are always made after the book block measurements.

3. DEFINE SIZE OF BOOK

I normally have my final sizes as 14x20cm. So I cut the edges of the freshly pressed nook to this size.

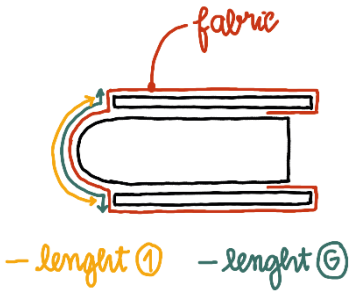
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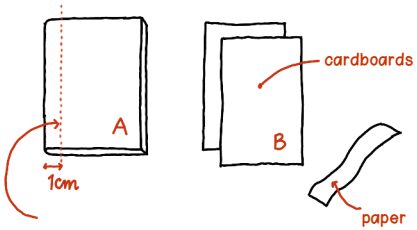




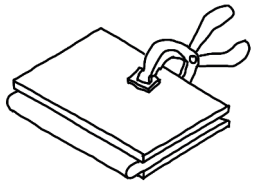
4. UNDERSTANDING THE COVER

For this project I have already calculated and given you the final size. The goal is to have the curved spine design, so for that the board will need to be pushed to the side.





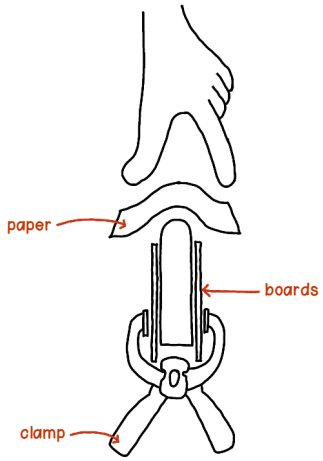
a. Start by making a 1cm off-set marking on the book block. Use a pencil for this.



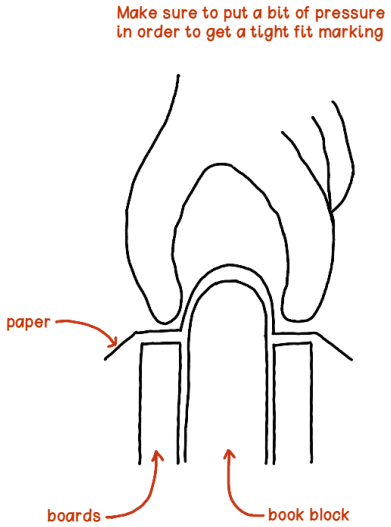
b. Align the card boars to the marks and clamp them all together.

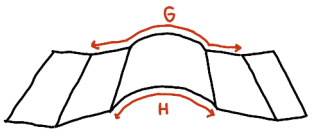
5. FIND THE WIDTH FOR THE COVER SPINE

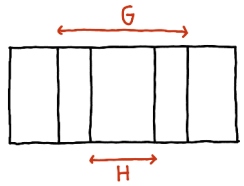
Find the distance between the boards before starting to glue the boards. That distance is the length the fabric will need to cover. You can easily measure thus by using a scrap piece of paper.



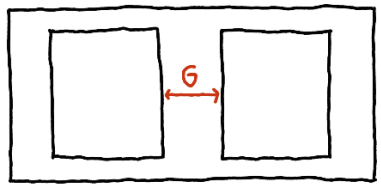
c. After that take the piece of paper and use it to trace the spine of the book and marking the edges where it meets the boards.







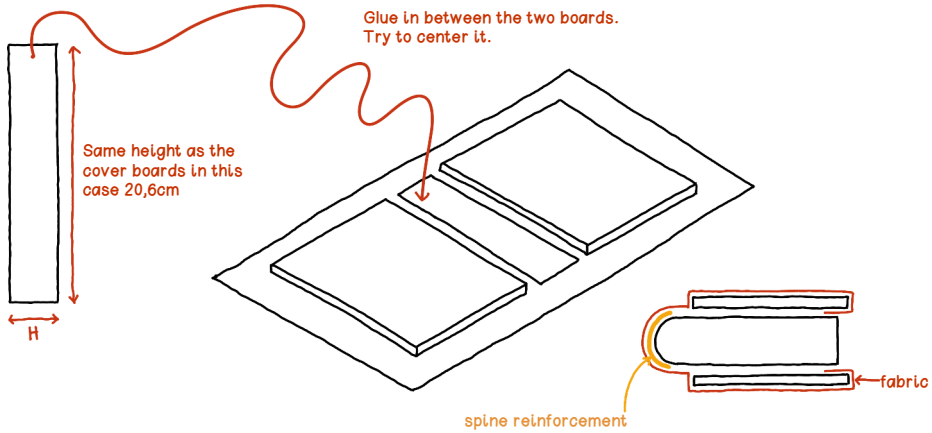
d. Open the piece of paper flat on the table, measure and write down both measurements, G and H.



6. PREPARE THE COVER

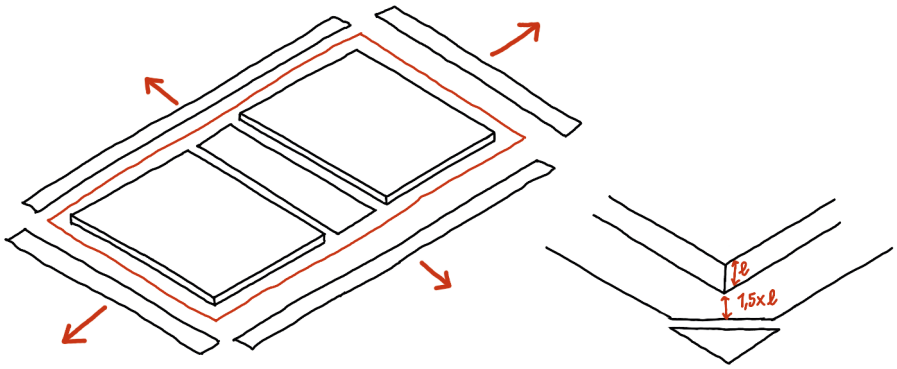
Glue the boards on the cover, centring them and using the measure "G" to place the boards next to each other.

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7. ADD SPINE REINFORCEMENT

In order to have a stronger curved spine on the cover I always add a thicker piece of paper. This piece of paper has the width "H" take from the book block. The idea is that the support touches only the book.

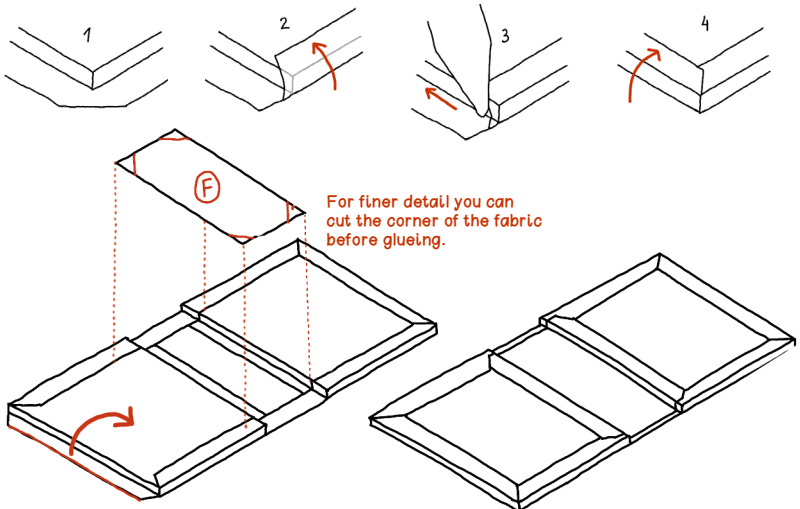


8. CUT EDGES EXCESS

Make sure that around the boards there is space left for folding. Do this by measuring or using a spacer for this. I normally leave 1,5cm, but you can use the width you prefer the most.

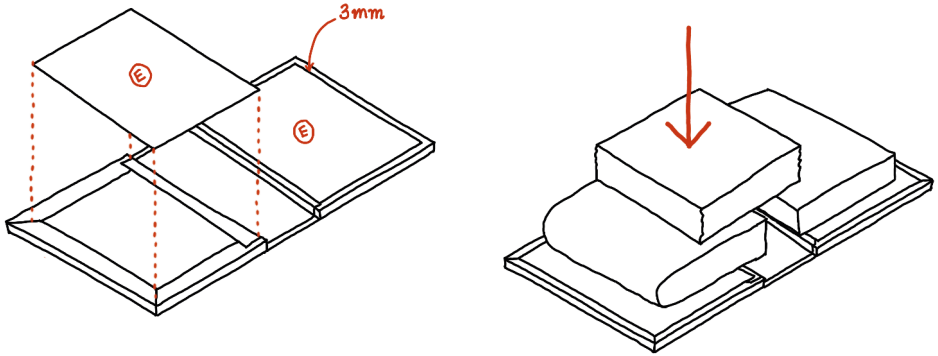
9. CUT THE CORNERS

Cut the corners for a clean fold. You can use the help of a corner jig (mitering tool). The idea is to make a cut close to 45 degrees and to have the right distance from the boards.



10. FOLD THE EDGES

Glue the edges on to the cover by folding them. When you are done, add the extra matching lining in the middle to have a nice finish on the spine on the inside. Pay attention to the corners when folding the first two edges(top and bottom first), follow instructions.



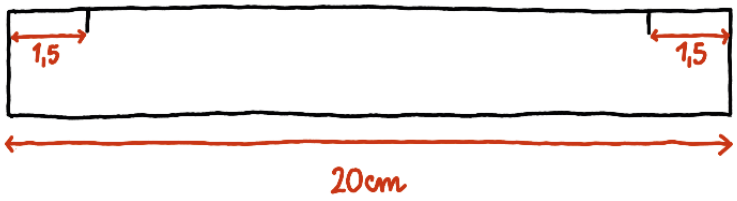
11. GLUE THE END-PAPERS

Take the endpapers "E" and glue them in place. The measure I gave you will make so that there is a very small part of the cover edge not covered with paper.

12. LET COVER DRY

Leave covers to dry on the side under pressure. I normally leave it on the side and use it the day after. But if you are in a rush, just an hour should be enough to start with.

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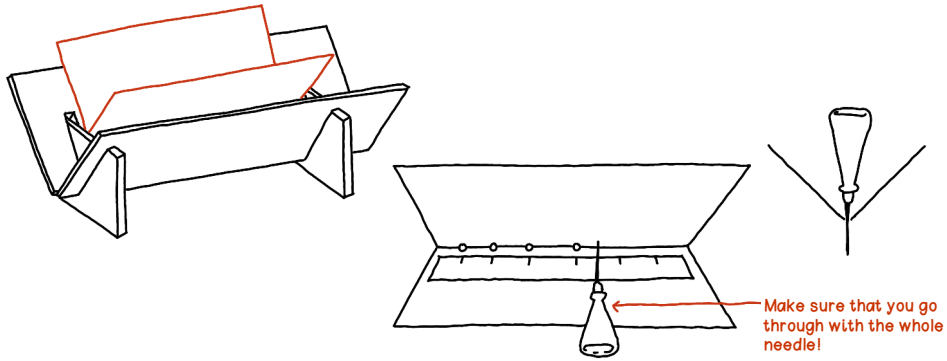
13. PREPARE THE PUNCHING GUIDE

To make a guide use a piece of paper that has the same height as the book block. In this case we you will use 20cm. Use a pencil to mark the distance from the top and bottom. I normally use 1,5cm for this.



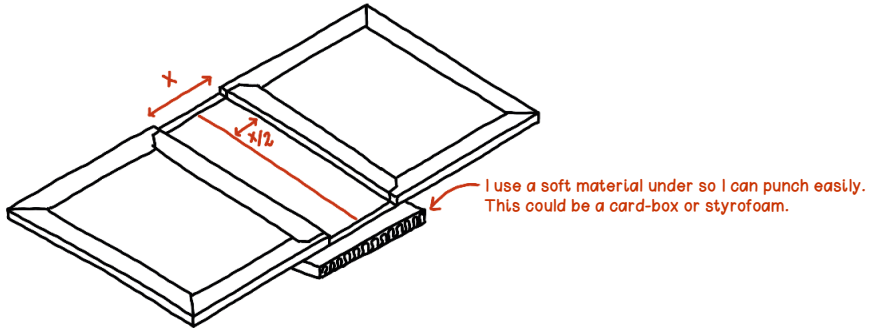
14. DESIGN YOUR PATTERN

Take the pencil and mark the other holes. I like to make it short and symmetric, so I use a distance f 1cm between the holes. You will have then 18 holes.



15- PUNCH THE SIGNATURE

Take your book block and punch the holes for the sewing. I use the help of the guide and punching cradle for this (you can download a tutorial to make your own cradle for free on my website, use code: "CRADLE 2024".



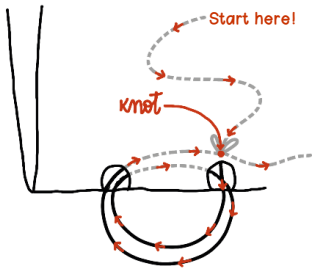
16. PUNCH THE COVER

Use the same guide and punch holes on the cover. Find first the centre of the spine, on the inside. I normally just use a pencil and draw directly on the spine. Once you sew the book this line will not be seen.

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17. SEW YOUR BOOK

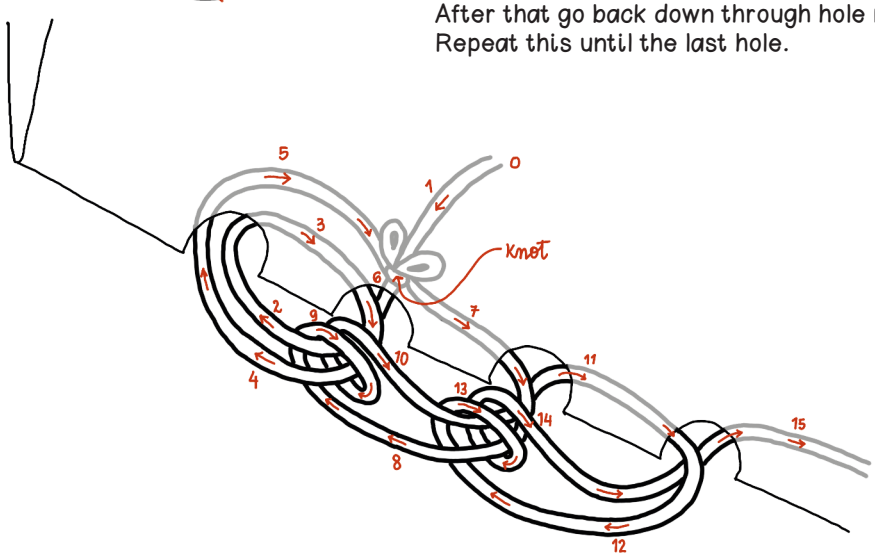
Follow the instructions and start sewing. Start from inside, hole nr 2. Make sure you leave enough thread behind to make a knot. After going through hole nr 2 (from inside) move up to hole nr 1. Go through the hole and down again through hole nr 2. The idea is to have two threads on the spine creating loops. Once you are inside again, after the second loop, make a knot.

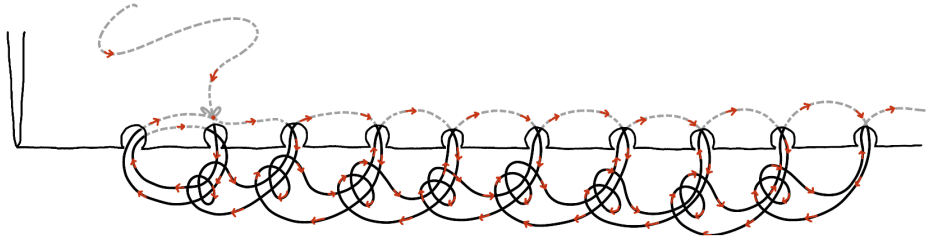


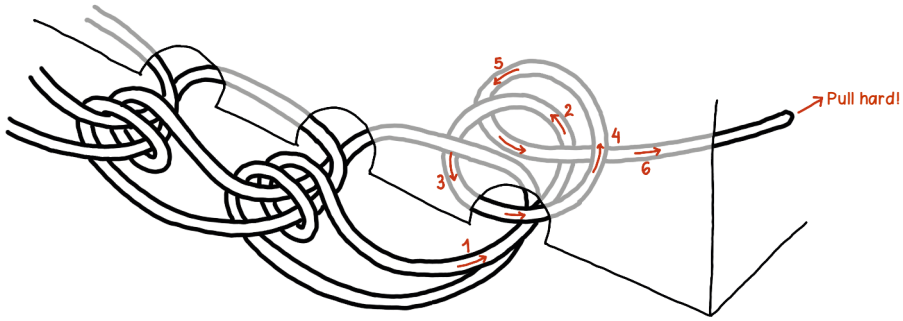
This sewing pattern is used only in the beginning. After the knot the loops will only happen on the outside part of the spine.

Go through the hole nr 3 and up the spine to make two loops through the threads you sew previously (steps 8, 9, 10 on sketch bellow).

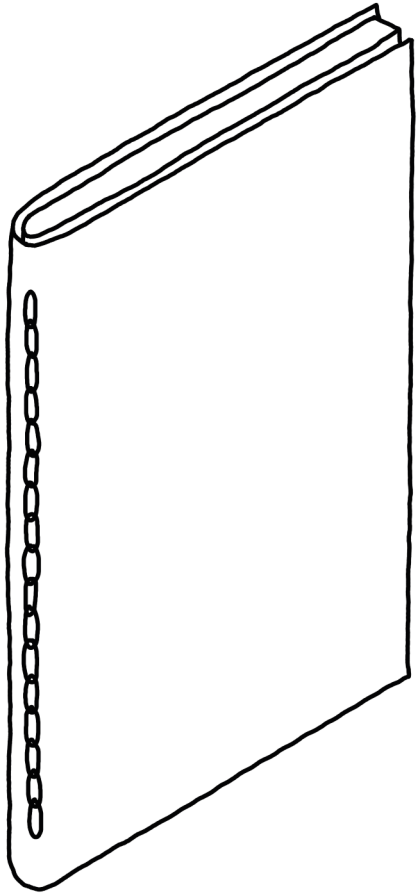
After that go back down through hole nr 3. Repeat this until the last hole.







When you are done with the last double loop, on the last hole, it's time for a final knot. This one is done on the inside.



18. PRESS YOUR BOOK!

Congrats! You have now finished your first single case notebook with a sewn dash stitch.

Put your boon on a press ideally for the next 24hours. To make sure you get it nicely flat and ready to use.

Enjoy!

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